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Global Tech Headlines | 6 November 2026

Five original English headlines with direct publisher links and exact source excerpts.

This Week

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01 · GLOBAL TECH NEWS

It's a weird time to buy a laptop, but the new MacBook Pro doesn't skimp on quality

Ars Technica · 2026-11-06

Apple’s new MacBook Pro is expensive as hell.

Let’s get that out there right away, because for a lot of people, it will be the only thing that matters. As with so many things in life, though, you get what you pay for. There’s no questioning the quality of the laptop’s display or most of its other hardware components.

But should you buy it? Well, that’s a complicated question in 2026.

We’re in a time of great uncertainty when it comes to buying a computer. Prices are at levels we’ve not seen in recent history, and they may well keep climbing. Meanwhile, users paying close attention to the early developments in both local and agentic artificial intelligence are asking an important question: “What will computing even look like in a few years, and what does that mean for the computer I should buy today?”

Apple’s new MacBook Pro sits at the intersection of all of this uncertainty. In multiple ways, it’s also straddling different worlds.

It arrives amid a changing of the guard in Apple’s leadership, potentially raising questions about the future direction of Apple’s ecosystem. It’s a mass-market consumer product, but configuring it with enough RAM and storage to make it feel future-proof pushes its price into territory mostly only well-funded businesses can afford.

Source: https://arstechnica.com/apple/2026/11/its-a-weird-time-to-buy-a-laptop-but-the-new-macbook-pro-doesnt-skimp-on-quality

02 · GLOBAL TECH NEWS

The Verge’s 2026 holiday gift guide

The Verge · 2026-11-06

Gift-giving isn’t just about grabbing something solid under a determined spending limit. It’s an expression of love, a way to show someone how well you really know them. That doesn’t mean you have to do it all on your own, though. Sometimes you just need a push in the right direction to get things rolling.

This year, we spent hours collecting our favorites to help you get ahead of your holiday shopping. This list has everything: minimalist smart rings , Play-Doh flowers , sleek beat machines — you name it. Whatever your needs, no matter how demanding the recipient, you’ll find something exceptional below for that special someone on your list.

Most of us have thousands of photos in the cloud, but if a photo never makes it into the real world, did it really happen? Existentialism aside, the Cricut StickerPix offers a new way to play with photos, providing you with everything you need to turn any picture into a pro-quality print or sticker.

Source: https://theverge.com/gadgets/1026041/holiday-gift-guide-2026

03 · GLOBAL TECH NEWS

At least 10 local governments have moved to drop Flock’s surveillance cameras since summer

TechCrunch · 2026-11-06

At least 10 local governments and police departments have moved since this summer to curb, restrict, or end their use of Flock Safety technology as concerns about mass surveillance and data privacy continue to grow . The backlash is part of a broader pushback against the rapid adoption of advanced AI technology, including the data center buildout, facial recognition, and other uses of AI.

Flock, founded in 2017, sells surveillance software that can help solve crimes, such as finding missing people or stolen cars. Its products include license plate readers, drones, and microphone-based edge-computing devices to pick up gunshots and other sounds. More than 100,000 Flock cameras are in use nationwide.

But in the past three months, Monroe , Ohio; Newburgh , New York; Richmond , Virginia; Hopkinton, Massachusetts; New Bedford , Massachusetts; and Lansing , Michigan, have all moved to end their contracts with Flock. Meanwhile, police in East Bridgewater and Grafton, Massachusetts, also announced plans to stop using Flock cameras.

Source: https://techcrunch.com/2026/11/05/at-least-10-local-governments-have-moved-to-drop-flocks-surveillance-cameras-since-summer

04 · SILICON VALLEY

How To Challenge A Monopoly In The AI Age

Crunchbase News · 2026-11-06

By R K Anand

If you were in Silicon Valley in the late 1990s, today's AI boom might feel familiar. In 1998 and 1999, internet traffic was roughly doubling every six to nine months. That was extraordinary growth in demand, and still, that pales in comparison to what we're seeing unfold now.

Today, the four largest U.S. cloud companies are looking at more than $700 billion in capital spending this year, and the cumulative AI infrastructure spending is projected to reach $3 trillion to $4 trillion by 2030.

Nvidia arguably fired the starting gun in AI chips when Jensen Huang hand-delivered its DGX-1 to OpenAI in 2016. Today, it is a household name deeply embedded in the AI ecosystem, working with near-exclusive supply and investment deals.

With such a huge market under a seeming monopoly, where can competition — and the innovation that follows it — come from?

Part of the answer is that scale costs you speed, though when going up against an execution machine like Nvidia this is simply the baseline you have to solve for. The pace of change in AI outruns anything we saw in previous tech cycles: Model generations turn over in weeks, not years.

Source: https://news.crunchbase.com/ai/challenging-monopolies-semiconductors-anand-tensordyn

05 · THINK TANK WATCH

Gaining (and losing) currency: a global database of currencies, 1850-2026

Bank for International Settlements · 2026-11-06

Gaining (and losing) currency:
a global database of currencies, 1850–2026*
Iñaki Aldasoro Jon Frost Rudraksh Kansal Catherine Schenk
November 2026
Abstract
Over the past two centuries, officially issued currencies have become firmly entrenched as a nearly universal institution in economies around the world.

But the
path to this arrangement has not been smooth: currencies have come and gone, in line with political changes, periods of hyperinflation or currency reforms and, in some cases, entry into currency unions. With a new global database of historical currencies over 1850–2026, we document 568 currencies, of which 163 are still in use today.

The median lifespan of a currency is 33 years, though there is substantial variation: from several currencies that lasted less than a year, to others that have circulated for several centuries. The most common reason for issuing a new currency is the independence of a jurisdiction (28% of cases); the most common reason for discontinuing one is a name or unit change (35%). Currencies are thus often born for political reasons, but they often die for economic ones.

Source: https://bis.org/publications/working-paper-1392-gaining-and-losing-currency-global-database-currencies-1850-2026.pdf

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